

Theseus — Quick Start

Guide 1 of 6

TL;DR

Theseus is three programs that work together. **Dialectic** listens to your conversations on the desktop and writes a structured transcript. **Noosphere** is the workshop — a background engine — that turns recorded material into a navigable library of claims, principles, and conclusions. **Theseus Codex** is the website where you sign in, upload material, review what the workshop has produced, and explore the firm's working memory. By the end of this guide (about forty minutes) you will have signed in, taken a short walk through the dashboard, recorded a five-minute Dialectic session, watched the analysis land in the Codex, uploaded one document, browsed the resulting claims and conclusions, asked the Oracle a question, and seen how a Currents opinion is formed.

You will need

- Your firm credentials. Your account was seeded for you; there is no public signup. If you do not have a working sign-in yet, contact whoever onboarded you.
- A browser pointed at the Codex (www.theseuscodex.com or your firm's deployment URL).
- The Dialectic desktop app installed (Dialectic.dmg for macOS or Dialectic-Setup.exe for Windows; both are on the firm's GitHub releases page).
- A working microphone.
- One short document you are willing to upload as the first corpus item — a memo, transcript, essay, or PDF. Public material is easiest for a first walkthrough.
- Roughly forty uninterrupted minutes.

This guide does NOT cover

- How extraction, clustering, principles, and conclusions work inside the workshop — see Guide 2.
- The Oracle's citation contract, abstention, and hallucination warning in depth — Guide 3.
- How Currents pulls in events, gates them, and generates opinions — Guide 4.
- Prediction markets, the Market Decision Trace, paper vs. live, and the eight-gate safety architecture — Guide 5.
- Operator-only surfaces (publication approval, methodology review week, kill switches, deletion vs. retraction, live-bet authorization) — Guide 6.

1 What Theseus is

Theseus is a small research and investment firm whose product is its *recorded reasoning*, not just its opinions. The three programs that make that possible are:

- **Dialectic** (desktop app). Runs on your laptop during a meeting or recording. It listens through the microphone, transcribes what people say in near real time, breaks the running transcript into *claims* (one-sentence assertions), and quietly flags when two claims pull against each other. When you stop, it ships an analyzed file straight up to the Codex on your behalf.
- **Noosphere** (the workshop). Takes any recorded material — a Dialectic session, an essay, a PDF, an audio file — and produces an organized view of it: atomic claims, distilled principles, a knowledge graph, six-layer coherence checks, adversarial objections, methodology profiles, time-tracked snapshots. It also runs the live pipelines for Currents and Forecasts. You never interact with it directly; it runs against material uploaded to the Codex.
- **Theseus Codex** (website + desktop wrapper). Two faces of one site. The *public face* is what readers see at `theseuscodex.com`. The *founder control plane* (signed in) is roughly seventy pages: upload, library, knowledge, conclusions, contradictions, explorer, founder Currents, founder Forecasts, account, and more.

The three pieces share one database, so anything the workshop writes appears on the Codex immediately, and anything Dialectic uploads gets handed straight to the workshop.

2 Two kinds of founder, one shared platform

It helps to know up front that the platform has *two access levels*, and most founders will only ever use the first one:

- **Founder**. Can sign in, upload material, browse and review everything the workshop produces, ask the Oracle, watch Currents and Forecasts, submit principles for triage, and respond to reader engagement. This is what this guide and Guides 2–5 cover.
- **Founder-alpha** (operator). All of the above plus the operator surfaces: approving conclusions for publication, signing the quarterly methodology review week, flipping kill switches, authorizing live forecasts, performing deletions or retractions, managing roles and credentials. This is Guide 6’s territory. You can read Guide 6 to *understand* what founder-alpha does, but the UI for those surfaces will not be clickable for you.

If you ever land on a page that requires operator privileges, the Codex shows a clear “operator only” notice and links you back to **Dashboard**.

3 Your forty-minute first session

3.1 Step 1 — sign in to the Codex (3 min)

Open the Codex URL in your browser. Enter your email and password. On success you land on **Dashboard**. The Codex is two surfaces in one app: when signed out, visitors see the firm’s public face (reviewed conclusions, articles, Currents, forecasts); once signed in you see the founder control plane.

The left rail of the founder control plane has many sections. For now you only need eight, in this order: **Dashboard, Upload, Library, Knowledge, Conclusions, Ask, Currents, Account**.

[screenshot screenshots/01_quick_start_dashboard.png not yet captured — The authenticated dashboard. The active-principles rail is at the top; recent conclusions and uploads are below; an operations health card sits on the right.]

3.2 Step 2 — take a five-minute tour of the dashboard (5 min)

Read each card on the dashboard without clicking anything yet:

- **Active principles.** The firm's currently accepted principles, conviction-ranked. This is the spine of the firm's working memory — everything the platform does eventually cites these.
- **Recent conclusions.** Conclusions the workshop has written or updated lately, each with its confidence tier.
- **Recent uploads.** What the firm has been reading.
- **Drift / attention.** Things the system thinks you should look at — a principle whose meaning has been shifting, an unresolved contradiction, a source whose standing changed.
- **Operations health.** A quiet indicator that the Currents pipeline, embedding index, and forecasts portfolio are running. If anything is red, founder-alpha will know before you do.

3.3 Step 3 — install and sign in to Dialectic (5 min)

Download Dialectic from the firm's releases page and install it. Launch it. On first run it asks for the Codex URL and your firm credentials — the same email and password you used to sign in to the website. Dialectic does the rest behind the scenes; you do not handle any API key or token yourself.

Once you've signed in, the credentials are stored locally on your machine with restrictive file permissions. You only sign in once per machine.

3.4 Step 4 — record a short Dialectic session (10 min)

Click **Begin session**. Talk for five to ten minutes about anything you have opinions on — a decision the firm is considering, a thesis you want to develop, a recent piece of writing. While you talk, the window shows:

- A running transcript on the left.
- A small graph of claims as labeled dots. Each meaningful sentence becomes a dot.
- A **TENSIONS** panel that lights up if two of those claims look like they conflict.
- A **PROMPTS** panel where the optional interlocutor (off by default) can suggest a follow-up.

When you're done, click **Stop session**. Dialectic saves the analyzed file locally and, because you're signed in, ships it up to the Codex automatically. The original audio stays on your laptop — it is never auto-uploaded.

[screenshot screenshots/01_quick_start_dialectic.png not yet captured — Dialectic's three-pane window: transcript on the left, claim graph in the middle, tensions and prompts on the right.]

3.5 Step 5 — watch the session land on the Codex (3 min)

Switch to the Codex. Open **Library** (the org-wide upload inventory) or **Upload**. Your new session is there, with a small `processing` badge. Click into it. The detail page shows a live, streaming view of the workshop's progress as it runs: extracting claims, embedding them, distilling principles, checking coherence, generating adversarial objections.

When the workshop finishes, the badge clears, the upload's status becomes `ingested`, and counts appear next to the row: how many claims were extracted, how many were grouped into principle candidates, how many methodology profiles were produced.

3.6 Step 6 — upload one document for breadth (3 min)

Open **Upload**. Drag in one written document — PDF, markdown, plain text, or a `.docx`. Hit submit. The file goes through the same pipeline: extraction, chunking, embedding, claim extraction, etc.

Watch the progress until the row is ingested.

Now you have two sources in the corpus: your spoken session and one written piece. That's the minimum for everything below to feel real.

3.7 Step 7 — explore Knowledge and Conclusions (5 min)

Open **Knowledge**. You will see your uploads listed with their claim counts. Click into one and browse the extracted claims — short, declarative statements, each carrying a pointer back to the exact span in the source it came from. Click any claim to jump to that source span.

Open **Conclusions**. These are the firm's vetted positions, including ones the workshop has just drafted from your two uploads. Each conclusion has a confidence tier (*firm / founder / open*), its supporting claims, its source uploads, any contradictions raised against it, and a *principle shape*: what kind of principle it is (rule, criterion, mechanism, heuristic, definition, formula, algorithm), its domain of applicability, and any quantifiable proxies. Guide 2 takes this surface apart in detail.

[screenshot screenshots/01_quick_start_knowledge.png not yet captured — The Knowledge surface, showing extracted claims with provenance back to their source spans.]

3.8 Step 8 — ask the Oracle (5 min)

Open **Ask**. Type a question that the material you just uploaded would plausibly bear on. The Oracle answers in the firm's voice, with inline citations to the specific claims, conclusions, or principles it leaned on. Click any citation to jump to the source.

Two things to expect on a first session:

- The Oracle will sometimes **abstain** ("the corpus does not contain enough relevant material to answer this"). That is deliberate. The Oracle is built to refuse rather than fabricate.
- It may show a **hallucination badge** if its prose paraphrases beyond what the citations strictly support. Read the cited spans, decide whether the paraphrase is honest, narrow your question if needed.

Guide 3 explains the full citation contract, the confidence bands, and how to read these warnings.

3.9 Step 9 — glance at Currents (3 min)

Open **Currents**. This is the firm's live commentary surface: if the Currents pipeline has been running and the corpus has anything substantive to say about recent X posts, you'll see opinions here, each grounded in specific firm conclusions. Each opinion's audit trail shows the source post, which conclusions supported it, the relevance scores, and the generator metadata. If the corpus is too thin on a topic, you will see explicit abstentions rather than thin prose.

Currents is also the place to develop a feel for the firm's voice in the wild. Guide 4 walks the pipeline end to end.

3.10 Step 10 — glance at Forecasts (1 min)

Open **Forecasts**. You'll see prediction-market opportunities (cards) from Polymarket and Kalshi that the firm has scored. Each card carries a firm probability prediction, a citation chain, a deterministic decision trace, and a paper or live status. *Live trading is operator-only*: as a founder you can see what the firm has forecast and how those forecasts have resolved, but the actual authorization to place real-money bets goes through founder-alpha. Guide 5 explains the architecture so you understand what's behind each card.

3.11 Step 11 — where to go next

You have now touched every primary surface. The pattern to internalize:

- Material enters through **Upload** (manually) or through Dialectic’s auto-sync (during a conversation).
- The workshop processes it, writing **Knowledge**, **Conclusions**, methodology profiles, contradictions, and principle drafts back into the Codex.
- You browse, triage, and respond on the founder control plane.
- You ask questions through **Ask**, watch **Currents** for live commentary, and **Forecasts** for prediction-market action.
- Founder-alpha approves what’s ready for the world. Once approved, the public site picks it up.

4 What you just saw, in one picture

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microphone → Dialectic           → Codex upload row → workshop
upload form → Codex upload row   → workshop         → knowledge graph
X / RSS     → Currents scheduler → EventOpinion     → public feed
Polymarket → Forecasts scheduler → Prediction        → paper or live bet

```

Everything that follows in the other five guides refines one of these four rows.

5 Common first-session frictions

- **Dialectic can’t sign in.** Check that the Codex URL is the one your firm uses. If your password isn’t working, your account may need a reset — ask founder-alpha.
- **Dialectic finishes but the upload doesn’t appear in the Codex.** Network errors are logged but never block the UI; the analyzed file is still on disk. Wait a minute and refresh **Library**; if nothing shows up, mention it on the firm’s internal channel.
- **Upload sits in processing for a long time.** Long PDFs and audio files take longer. If processing exceeds a few minutes, check the dashboard’s operations card to see whether the workshop is healthy.
- **The Oracle says “I don’t have enough sources.”** Correct behavior with a thin corpus. Upload more on the topic, or narrow the question. Guide 3 explains what to do with the response.
- **No Currents opinions are appearing.** Either the ingestion path is paused or the corpus doesn’t have enough relevant material yet. Either way, founder-alpha will know before you do.

6 Where the docs are

- docs/Theseus_Codex_User_Guide.pdf — the older single-document Codex walkthrough, still useful as a backup.
- dialectic/README.md — the Dialectic install notes.
- The other five guides in this series.

Where to read next

Continue with [Guide 2 — Knowledge and Principles](#) for how the firm turns the material you just uploaded into reusable principles and vetted conclusions. That guide picks up the moment your upload's badge clears.